

F6 English SP — Lesson 5 (DSE 2013 Paper 1 Part B1)

TEACHER'S VERSION & ANSWER KEY WITH EXPLANATIONS

Reading: Part B1 · Text 2 “Master teaches a much-loved instrument” + Text 3 “What your updates say about you” · 11 open-ended questions (12 marks) · skill taught: metaphor & simile (Q10)

Part A Key vocabulary — 10 difficult words worth learning (Answer Key)

Match each word or phrase (1–10) with the correct definition (A–J). Write the letter in the answer column.

No.	Word / phrase	Answer	Definition
1	comprise (Text 2, Line 37)	G	to consist of; to be made up of
2	intake (Text 2, Line 56)	E	a group of people admitted at one time (e.g. a new class of students)
3	tuition (Text 2, Line 34)	I	money paid for lessons; (also) teaching itself
4	posture (Text 2, Line 40)	D	the position in which you hold your body when sitting or standing
5	unwittingly (Text 3, Line 6)	B	by accident; without realising what you are doing
6	assumption (Text 3, Line 15)	H	an idea that you accept as true without proof
7	disclosures (Text 3, Line 35)	F	personal information that you reveal/make known to others
8	nocturnal (Text 3, Line 52)	C	active or happening at night
9	desperation (Text 3, Line 45)	J	a feeling of hopelessness / a strong need that makes you act without thinking
10	counterproductively (Text 3, Line 58)	A	in a way that has the opposite result to the one you intended

Answers: 1-G, 2-E, 3-I, 4-D, 5-B, 6-H, 7-F, 8-C, 9-J, 10-A

Part B Teaching focus — comparison questions (metaphor & simile)

Q10 (DSE Q44) “Why is Facebook compared to cigarettes and alcohol?” is the only comparison question in this paper, so the lesson teaches one skill: a comparison question is answered with the QUALITY the two things share. The student handout now carries two fresh examples (one simile, one metaphor) that are NOT the exam question — the exam sentence is kept back for the 12-mark practice at the end of the lesson.

Handout examples (student sheet, Part B)

SIMILE — The pressure before the public exams weighed on her shoulders like a mountain of lead. → the signal is written openly (like / as ... as / compared to / similar to): the shared quality is **heavy** — copy the quality, not the object.

METAPHOR — Landfills are ticking bombs that future generations have to deal with. → X IS Y with no “like” or “as”: what do landfills and ticking bombs share? Both are **dangerous and will cause serious harm later / if not dealt with now**.

How to answer — what do the two things SHARE? They are both ...

Deck teaching point (slides 4–5)

The two PPT demos are **separate made-up sentences** — a bee (easy simile) and a slot machine (difficult metaphor). They teach the skill; they never reuse the exam sentence, so Q10 is still a genuine test when students reach it.

Click order to hold in class: tips slide — simile card → metaphor card → how-to-answer card. Demo 1 — model answer. Demo 2 — “How to find it” strip FIRST, then the model answer. Question slides — evidence card, then the answer.

Question types in this paper (for reference)

Q1 reference/time (82%) · Q2 word-finding (43%) · Q3 reason (85%) · Q4 gap-fill (59%) · Q5 two points (34%) · Q6 inference (3%) · Q7 vocabulary in context (56%) · Q8 reference (33%) · Q9 reference (53%) · Q10 comparison — the taught skill (28%) · Q11 two-part (48% / 46%)

Part C Open-ended questions — the exercise (12 marks)

The 11 open-ended questions from DSE 2013 Paper 1 Part B1, in passage order. Percentages = 2013 candidate success rate (official marking scheme).

Q1. (DSE Q26) When did the guzheng become popular? (1 mark, 82%)

Answer: since ancient times /// during the Qin Dynasty

Both answers accepted. Text 2 ¶1: “The guzheng has been a popular Chinese instrument since ancient times. It originated during the Warring States period and first became popular during the Qin Dynasty.” Evidence: Text 2, ¶1 (lines 1–3)

Q2. (DSE Q28) Find a word in paragraph 2 that means the same as “unstable”. (1 mark, 43%)

Answer: turbulent

Word-finding question. ¶2: “After surviving the turbulent times of the Cultural Revolution...”. Clue: “turbulent times” = unstable times. Spelling: t-u-r-b-u-l-e-n-t. Evidence: Text 2, ¶2 (line 7)

Q3. (DSE Q29) According to Zou Lunlun, why do Chinese people want to learn the guzheng? (1 mark, 85%)

Answer: they have been exposed to its sound since childhood

Reason question — signal “because”. ¶3: “Chinese people are attracted to learning the guzheng because they have been exposed to its sound since childhood.” Accept the full clause. Evidence: Text 2, ¶3 (lines 12–14)

Q4. (DSE Q30) Use ONE word to complete each blank: Zou believes Westerners like the guzheng because it sounds _____ and _____. (1 mark, 59%)

Answer: exotic / relaxing

Gap-fill, TWO blanks but ONE mark for the item — the marking scheme gives a single bracket, so BOTH words must be right to earn the mark. ¶4: "...because of its exotic and relaxing sound." Evidence: Text 2, ¶4 (lines 17–19)

Q5. (DSE Q35) How does the Leisure and Cultural Services Department select students for their guzheng courses? (1 mark, 34%)

Answer: (passing an) interview and (taking a music aptitude) test — must include BOTH points to receive 1 mark

¶10: "Acceptance is based on an interview and a music aptitude test with the next intake in August." The marking scheme explicitly says both points are needed — this is the trap of the question. Evidence: Text 2, ¶10 (lines 54–56)

Q6. (DSE Q37) What does the first paragraph suggest about social media? (1 mark, 3%)

Answer: it questions whether social media is good /// it suggests that social media is not always good /// social media may not be that great / may not be as good as we think

The trick: paragraph 1 opens "Social media is great for deepening bonds... Or is it?" — the rhetorical "Or is it?" undermines the positive claim. Hardest question in the paper (3%). Show students how "Or is it?" flips the meaning. Evidence: Text 3, ¶1 (lines 1–4)

Q7. (DSE Q39) According to paragraph 2, what are some users doing by accident? (1 mark, 56%)

Answer: revealing undesirable personal traits (to their peers)

"by accident" = "unwittingly" in ¶2: "...power users... are unwittingly revealing undesirable personal traits to their peers." The answer copies the phrase after "unwittingly". Evidence: Text 3, ¶2 (lines 6–8)

Q8. (DSE Q40) In line 15, "This assumption" refers to... (1 mark, 33%)

Answer: (the idea) that Facebook could be a fantastic place for people to strengthen their relationships

Reference question. "This assumption" points BACK to ¶3, the idea Forest describes: "Facebook could be a fantastic place for people to strengthen their relationships." Teach: read backwards from the reference word. Evidence: Text 3, ¶3–4 (lines 12–15)

Q9. (DSE Q43) What does "it" (line 41) refer to? (1 mark, 53%)

Answer: a negative reaction

Reference question. ¶8: "But when people have a negative reaction to a post on Facebook, they seem to keep it to themselves." "it" = the negative reaction. Again: read back to the noun before. Evidence: Text 3, ¶8 (lines 40–41)

Q10. (DSE Q44) Why is Facebook compared to cigarettes and alcohol? (1 mark, 28%)

Answer: Facebook is as addictive as cigarettes and alcohol /// it is addictive /// it is (like) an addiction /// users become addicts

Comparison question — the skill taught in Part B. ¶9: “...with evidence that Facebook is as addictive as cigarettes and alcohol.” The answer is the point of similarity: addictiveness. Students must write the SHARED QUALITY, never the objects themselves (“because they are similar” earns no mark). Evidence: Text 3, ¶9 (lines 46–47)

Q11. (DSE Q45) i) In what way could social networking websites help people with low self-esteem? ii) In what way can social networking websites be harmful to people with low self-esteem? (2 marks, 48% / 46%)

Answer i): they can share things on Facebook /// it can help them improve their friendship /// help them make (new) friends /// help them build up their self-esteem
Answer ii): they bombard their friends with negative tidbits about their lives /// they may alienate themselves from their friends /// they may become less likeable

TWO parts = 1 mark each. i) = the “In theory” half of ¶10 (sharing strengthens friendships); ii) = the “But in practice” half (bombarding friends with negative tidbits, becoming less likeable). Teach: give exactly the two ideas from ¶10. Evidence: Text 3, ¶10 (lines 52–58)